

bubbles, live music, crafts, and booths from local businesses.

One recurring attraction, Maniac Pumpkin Carvers, has been a mainstay at Addams Family Fun Day since the beginning. Founded by friends Chris Soria and Marc Evan, the company uses pumpkins as canvases, carving all sorts of designs to fit AddamsFest's yearly theme. "A lot of people really appreciate the artwork," Soria says. "It's a great opportunity for us to share our craft with people."

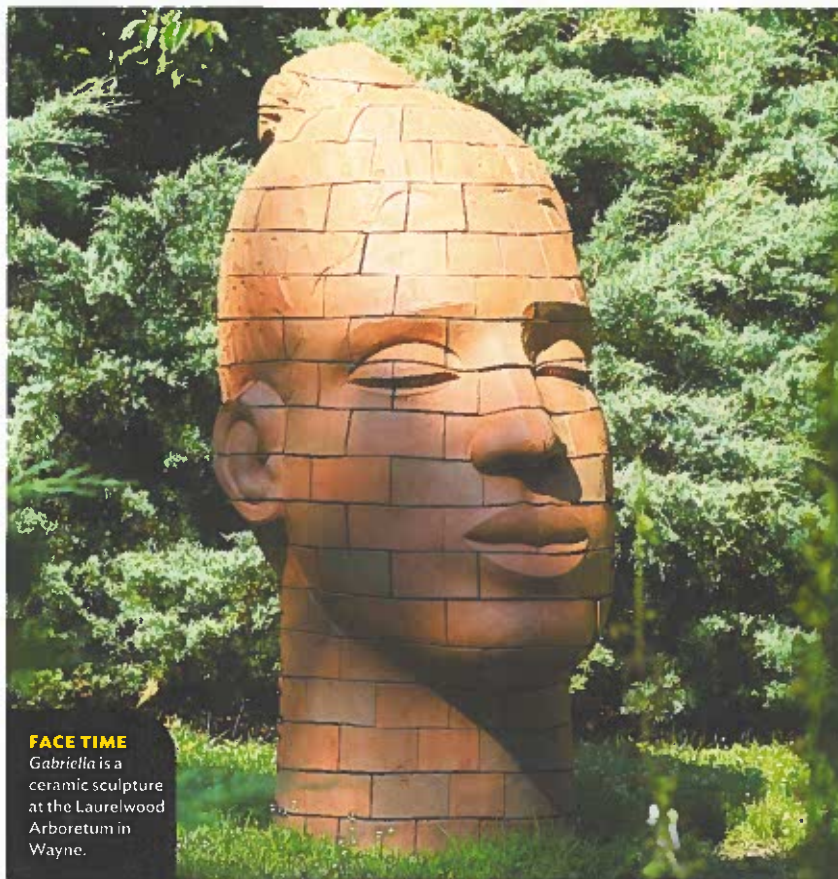
A Morticia-and-Gomez-themed masquerade ball, where guests get decked out as Addams Family characters, takes place on October 10 at the James Ward Mansion.

The festival's inception came about seven years ago, when creator and chairperson Dawn Mackey, then in her first days as a Westfield councilwoman, took inspiration from BlobFest, an annual festival in Phoenixville, Pennsylvania, where the 1958 movie *The Blob* was filmed. Westfield's adaptation, a tribute to its most famous former resident, was a no-brainer, and plans for a month-long Addams celebration soon commenced.

Baked into the festival is an appreciation for the cartoonist's upbringing in Westfield and his lasting impact on pop culture. In 1938, he created the Addams Family characters as a cartoonist for *The New Yorker*, which famously spawned several movies and TV shows over the years, including the current hit, *Wednesday*.

An interesting piece of Addams's early art can still be seen in town. As a teenager in the 1920s, Addams graffitied a skel-

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FACE TIME
Gabiella is a ceramic sculpture at the Laurelwood Arboretum in Wayne.

TAKE IT OUTSIDE

These sculpture gardens integrate artwork made of stainless steel, stone, bronze and more into lush Garden State landscapes, offering outdoor galleries to stroll at your own pace.

BY RON SHIPMON

LAURELWOOD ARBORETUM'S SCULPTURE TRAIL

Wayne

This 30-acre botanical jewel's walking trail showcases 15 sculptures. Behind this visionary trail are Laurelwood volunteers and Pines Lake residents Stuart and Leslie Reiser, whose dedication fueled the project.

Curated by Scott A. Broadfoot, the sculptures are available for purchase, with a portion of the proceeds donated to the arboretum. Guided tours are available.

725 Pines Lake Drive West. Daily, 8 AM until dusk. Golf carts are available. laurelwoodarboretum.org. Entrance is free; donations are accepted.

CLIFTON ARTS CENTER AND SCULPTURE PARK

Clifton

The narrative of the Clifton Art Center and Sculpture Park began in 1994 with the vision and dedication of former mayor and councilwoman Gloria Kolodziej. Following the passing of her husband, Kolodziej embarked on civic leadership that championed the arts. Kolodziej, along with a team of supporters, transformed a 26-acre municipal parcel into an outdoor-gallery park.

Clifton's Sculpture Park, one of the few municipal art parks in the nation, has laid the groundwork for an indoor arts center as well. The 26-acre municipal complex has

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SPOOKY

events around town

WITCH-CRAFT
Paradise Lakes Campgrounds, Hammonton
This adults-only fest features costume contests, fortune telling and more. Camp overnight for added fun.

Dates: OCT 10-11
Admission: \$27 and up
Info: witchcraftnj.com

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PRINCETON

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Collects highlights transformative works of art donated in honor of the museum's new building, including major paintings by artists such as Mark Rothko, Joan Mitchell and Gerhard Richter. *Toshiko Takaue: Dialogues in Clay* shows the ceramic works of the abstract artist and Princeton professor.

The museum also features four large-scale commissions by the artists Nick Cave, Diana Al-Hadid, Tuan Andrew Nguyen and Jane Irish, and two outdoor sculpture acquisitions by the artists Jun Kaneko and Rose B. Simpson.

If you want to enjoy the outdoors while you're in Princeton, visit **Herrontown Woods Arboretum**. Open to the public every day at no cost, it features several miles of walking trails over its 142 acres. The original woods were donated by renowned mathematician Oswald Veblen of the nearby **Institute for Advanced Study**, and the house and cottage that he owned with his wife have also been added to the woods.

Terhune Orchards is celebrating its 50th anniversary this year and is marking the occasion with special events. In addition to the farm's 250-year-old historic barn, there are a winery, farm store and **Barn Door Café**. On Saturdays and Sundays through November 2, there are fall family-fun festivals being held at the farm, including pick-your-own pumpkins and apples, a cornstalk maze and more.

For those who are more culturally minded, the **McCarter Theatre Center** in Princeton is a prominent performing arts center known for diverse programming, including theater, dance and musical events. This fall, the musical *I & U* runs through October 12, and a conversation with the writer David Sedaris takes place October 3. The play *300 Paintings* will run in November.

There are many wonderful spots to dine in Princeton, including **Agricola** on Witherspoon Street, which earned a spot on *New Jersey Monthly's* Top 40 list this year. This creative and popular farm-to-table restaurant, with an open kitchen and cool atmosphere, is known for its fresh, locally sourced ingredients from their own Great Road Farm and other local purveyors.

For ice cream, in addition to the iconic **Bent Spoon**, check out **Halo Pub** on Palmer Square, with its own locally made, premium, artisanal ice cream produced with milk from its own dairy. 🍦

SCULPTURE GARDENS

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more than 30 sculptures.

Clifton City Hall Complex on Well Road, at 900 Clifton Avenue. 1 to 4 PM Wednesday–Saturday. cliftonartcenter.org
Suggested admission, \$3; donations are welcome.

SCULPTURE FOR LEONIA

Leonia

Sculpture for Leonia is an all-volunteer nonprofit dedicated to adorning the town's streets with art. Established in 2006, this initiative has placed more than 50 sculptures, lent by the artists. The artwork, scattered across town, finds its focal point in the Erika and David Boyd Sculpture Garden, which honors the namesake artists, at the intersection of Broad Avenue and Beechwood Place.

Once celebrated as an art colony, Leonia was home to renowned American painters such as Charles Chapman, Harvey Dunn and William Merritt Chase.

Erika and David Boyd Sculpture Garden, 305 Beechwood Place. Daily, 6 AM–9 PM. Visit sculptureforleonia.org to access a digital map of installations. **Entrance is free.**

HADDONFIELD OUTDOOR SCULPTURE TRUST (HOST)

Haddonfield

In 2012, resident Stuart Harting founded HOST, a union of public and private collaborations with the borough that furnishes the downtown area with figurative and abstract outdoor sculptures.

The art is a mix of permanent installations and transient pieces, some on loan, some available for direct purchase from the artists. The evocative collection includes a graceful ballerina, a stoic postman, a poignant refugee, a monumental red heart, and a whimsical menagerie housed at the Haddonfield Children's Sculpture Zoo. 🦒

Haddonfield Children's Sculpture Zoo, 338 Kings Highway East. For a digital map of a self-guided tour, visit haddonfieldsculpture.org. **Entrance is free.**

Ron Shipmon is an art collector, curator, advisor, and USPAP-certified art appraiser, with over three decades of experience.